Henrietta High-Stakes

The business partner of Harry High-Stakes (the Deadwood Cantina owner), you have not always (and still do not) have a solid partnership. Your partnership troubles started over six years ago when Harry left you to seek out fortune in the Black Hills. When Harry originally left, you expected him to be gone for a few months, but he didn't return for nearly five years! When Harry returned a little less than a year ago, he seemed genuine about seeking your forgiveness and wanting to start a new business with you. Because of Harry's apparent devotion to starting over, you found it in your heart to forgive him and attempted to rebuild your old friendship. Your decision to stay with Harry was in part due to the fact that in Harry's time away, he had accumulated some gold. With Harry's newfound wealth, Harry established the Deadwood Cantina, promising you that his investment was all with the intention of providing a better life for you.

Despite Harry's good intentions, your partnership continues to struggle. Even after promising you a better life financially, you have witnessed Harry wasting cantina profits at the card tables. You are worried about the cantina's financial situation and you have heard rumors that the cantina may soon be reclaimed by the bank if Harry does not pay up. After expressing concern over the cantina's finances, Harry turned the books over to Billie-The-Bartender (the barmaid of the cantina). Even though you are not pleased with your partner, you do not want to lose the cantina. As a woman in the West, you know that if you split from Harry, you would receive nothing, but if your partner were to end up dead (or in jail), his share of the cantina would be yours. For that reason, you want Harry to keep the cantina. Knowing Harry would never want to lose you, you threatened to leave the business if he could not show you the proper (financial) attention that you deserve. Harry responded by giving you a rather expensive necklace that you adore.

In addition to your partnership problems with Harry, you are frustrated and irritated with the bankers in town, Banker Bob and Banker Bonnie. As the holders of the cantina loan, Banker Bonnie and Banker Bob are aware of the financial trouble that you are in and they are trying to take advantage of the situation. Rumor has it that Banker Bob has already sought out a new investor to purchase the cantina pending the foreclosure of the cantina. Recently, you have noticed Banker Bonnie frequenting the cantina and you wonder why she is spending so much time in your establishment. Just the other day you saw her having a sarsaparilla with Barb Cassidy. Whatever Banker Bonnie is up to, you do not like it.

In recent weeks, you have noticed the cantina girl's profits dwindling. Because of this, you mandated that your cantina girls only sell dance tickets to the highest-paying customers until the cantina is debt-free. Sally Starr (a devoted employee) was very saddened by this, since she admires Clay Coldwell (a low-paying customer), but you have every reason to believe that Sally will abide by your wishes.

As the Deadwood Cantina Poker Tournament Party approaches, you are looking forward to attending. Since the cantina is in desperate need of money, you are hoping for a great turnout! At the party, you plan to be the perfect hostess while also seeing how much money you can try to solicit for the cantina to keep it out of foreclosure.



Acting and Dressing Your Part: As the business partner of the organizer of this grand event, you relish being what you consider the center of this extravaganza. To the grand event, you will want to wear a fancy dress with a ruffled skirt, accompanied by the beautiful necklace that Harry High-Stakes gave you. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see please see the party tips section at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the guest info and costuming sections on the website.*

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